Session 1: What AI Can Do for You

Business Intelligence & AI

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Welcome

What We Covered in the Pre-Program Video

Quick recap

- **Course tools:** Claude.ai (browser), Claude Desktop (local files), Claude Code (building tools)
- **The arc:** personal productivity → enterprise data → deployment → strategy
- **XYZ Corp Data Simulation:** a $500M distributor simulation — starting in Week 2
- **By Session 8:** a concrete AI strategy for your organization

The “Why Now”

In February 2026, AI agents wiped **$2 trillion** from software company valuations.

The SAASpocalypse

"The AI agent revolution is wreaking havoc on traditional SaaS valuations. Investors are betting that **intelligent agents will replace** *the click-heavy workflows that enterprise software companies have spent decades building."*

— CNBC, "Software stocks face worst rout in a decade as AI agents threaten business models," February 2026

The Damage

−31% Salesforce

−32% Adobe

−35% Atlassian

What AI Is Replacing

The Interface Layer

- Click-heavy workflows
- Form-filling and navigation
- Manual data entry across screens
- “Training” users on software

Workflow Automation

- Rule-based routing
- Report scheduling
- Template-driven outputs
- Repetitive analysis tasks

Per-Seat Economics

- $150-300/user/month SaaS fees
- Shelfware (paid but unused)
- Feature bloat nobody asked for
- Integration tax between tools

What Survives

Data

The systems of record. The databases. The institutional knowledge embedded in your CRM, ERP, and HR systems.

AI does not replace your data — it makes it **accessible**.

Two Questions This Course Answers

1. Personal Productivity

How can **I** use AI + code to get the data I need, analyze it, and generate deliverables?

- Charts, documents, Excel, PowerPoint
- Iteration and self-critique
- Reusable workflows
- Available to you **right now**

2. Corporate Implementation

What should **my company** be doing to implement AI-assisted data handling and analysis?

- Enterprise data access and integration
- Deployment architecture and security
- Governance and verification
- The 90-day pilot plan

These are distinct but related. Personal productivity is Week 1. Corporate implementation is Weeks 2–4. The skills from the first feed directly into the second.

We Start With You

Before AI transforms your organization, it can transform your workday.

Demo: AI as Your Analyst

What You Are About to See

Chart Paste numbers, get an interactive visualization

→

Memo Turn the data into an executive summary

→

Slide Reformat as a PowerPoint-ready slide

→

3 Minutes Three deliverables, one conversation

The Key Framing

AI is a **fast junior analyst**.

It drafts. You direct and verify.

It is not replacing your judgment — it is accelerating your output.

And It Produces Real Files

Excel Workbooks

Formatted `.xlsx` files with formulas, multiple sheets, charts, and conditional formatting

Word Documents

Professional `.docx` files with headings, tables, page breaks, and styled formatting

PowerPoint Decks

`.pptx` slide decks with layouts, bullet points, charts, and speaker notes

Charts & Dashboards

Interactive visualizations, PDF reports, CSV exports — whatever format the task requires

These are not screenshots or mockups. AI generates **actual files** you can open, edit, and send. An executive summary as a Word doc. A financial model as an Excel workbook. A board deck as PowerPoint. We will produce all of these in this course.

Demo Walkthrough

Prompt → Output: Chart, Memo, Slide

The Prompt

What we typed

Here is quarterly revenue by product line (in $K):

Product Line	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Industrial	62,400	64,100	58,900	67,200
Energy	38,100	36,800	39,400	41,200
Safety	24,300	25,100	26,800	27,900

Create a bar chart comparing Q1 through Q4 revenue by product line.

The Output: Chart

> Claude generated an **interactive grouped bar chart** with color-coded product lines, hover tooltips showing exact values, and a legend. Total time: about 5 seconds.

The chart is not a static image — it is an **interactive artifact** you can hover over, filter, and export. Then I followed up: “Turn this into an executive summary memo” and “Now format it as a PowerPoint-ready slide.” Same data, three formats, under a minute total.

How AI + Code + Data Work Together

Three Moving Pieces

The AI Brain

- The large language model (LLM)
- **Usually in the cloud** — hosted by Anthropic, OpenAI, Google, etc.
- Can also run **on-premise** for sensitive data (Session 5)
- Understands your question
- Generates text, code, and plans

The Data

- Could be on **your computer** (spreadsheets, local files)
- Could be in **SaaS provider storage** (Salesforce, Workday, NetSuite)
- Could be on **company-managed servers** (on-prem or cloud)
- Where data lives determines security requirements

Code Execution

- Something has to run the Python, SQL, or scripts the AI writes
- Could run on **the LLM provider's hardware** (Claude.ai sandbox)
- Could run on **company servers** (Docker, on-prem)
- Could run on **your computer** (Claude Desktop, terminal)

How You Will Experience This in the Course

Three Ways to Work with AI + Code + Data

Option 1: Your Own Computer

- Install files provided (Python, Claude Code)
- Data and code execution on **your machine**
- AI brain in the cloud (requires Anthropic Pro account — not provided)
- Full control, full privacy
- **Optional** — for those who want the deepest experience

Option 2: AI+Code Lab

- A shared cloud environment with your own account. No software to install, no cost to you.
- Includes Claude Code and pre-loaded exercises
- Uses Claude xlsx, docx, and pptx skills, which execute Node.js and Python code
- Data and code execution on **the Lab**
- AI brain in the cloud (API key provided)
- **Simulates** working on your own computer — same experience, zero setup

Option 3: XYZ Corp Data Simulation

- Browser-based enterprise data simulation. No installation.
- 10 databases, 41 tables, 26,000+ rows
- Uses Claude xlsx, docx, and pptx skills, which execute Node.js and Python code
- Simulates corporate AI deployment — remote data, remote execution
- AI brain in the cloud

Mapping to the Architecture

	AI Brain	Data	Code Execution	Simulates
Your Computer	Anthropic cloud	Your local files	Your machine	Personal workstation
AI+Code Lab	Anthropic cloud	Lab files	Lab server	Personal workstation (no setup)
XYZ Corp Data Simulation	Anthropic cloud	Remote databases	Remote server	Corporate deployment

In this course, the AI brain is in the cloud. In production, it could also run on-premise. What changes is **where the data lives**, **where the code runs**, and **where the LLM runs**. Those are the deployment decisions every organization faces — and what Sessions 5 and 6 are about.

Hands-On: Your First Artifacts

Exercise 1: Build a Chart

Instructions

1. Paste the sample dataset (provided in chat) into Claude.ai
2. Ask: “Create a bar chart comparing Q1 through Q4 revenue by product line”
3. **Iterate:** “Change the colors to blue and gray” → “Add data labels” → “Switch to a line chart” → “Make it a stacked bar chart”
4. Notice the interactive artifact — hover, filter, explore

The point: You are not learning to code. You are learning to direct. Tell it what you want, see the result, refine with plain English.

Exercise 2: Build an Interactive Calculator

Instructions

1. Ask Claude: “Build me an interactive break-even analysis calculator”
2. It should have inputs for: fixed costs, variable cost per unit, selling price per unit
3. **Iterate:** “Add a chart showing profit/loss across different volumes” → “Add a sensitivity table” → “Make the inputs sliders instead of text boxes”
4. Try your own: ROI calculator, loan amortization, pricing model

Exercise 3: Draft an Executive Summary

Instructions

1. Open the briefing document (provided) — a two-page quarterly performance update
2. Paste it into Claude and ask: “Write a one-page executive summary for the CEO”
3. **Iterate:** “Make it half the length” → “Lead with the biggest risk” → “Add a recommendation section” → “Change the tone to be more direct”
4. Compare your iterations — notice how specific direction produces specific improvement

Open Exploration

Bring something from your actual work.

What to Try

Analyze

- Paste a dataset
- Ask for trends
- Request comparisons
- Generate charts

Draft

- Email to a client
- Meeting summary
- Project proposal
- Status update

Summarize

- Long report → key points
- Article → executive brief
- Meeting notes → action items
- Research → decision memo

Build

- Calculator or estimator
- Comparison matrix
- Decision framework
- Checklist or rubric

Breakout Discussion

Groups of 3-4

Discussion Questions

What surprised you?

- What did AI do better than expected?
- Where did it fall short?
- What was the quality like?

What would you use tomorrow?

- Which task from your real work fits best?
- What would you delegate to AI first?
- Where is the biggest time savings?

What patterns do you see?

- What tasks follow a repeatable pattern?
- Where do you spend time on structure, not substance?
- What recurring work could AI accelerate?

Group Debrief

Each group: share your one best insight.

The Maker/Checker Preview

The Maker

- AI generates the first draft
- Fast, tireless, format-flexible
- No domain expertise
- No sense of stakes or audience
- Will confidently produce wrong answers

The Checker

- You verify, refine, and approve
- Domain knowledge and judgment
- Understands the audience
- Knows what “wrong” costs
- The irreplaceable human role

The Spectrum of Trust

Low Stakes

Personal notes, brainstorming, exploration

→

Medium Stakes

Team decks, internal reports, summaries

→

High Stakes

Board decks, regulatory filings, public docs

→

Your Judgment

Match verification effort to consequences

Homework

Your Assignment This Week

Homework — Due Session 2

1. **Use Claude.ai for at least 3 real work tasks** — a chart, a document draft, an analysis, a summary, whatever fits your workflow. Screenshot or save the outputs.
2. **For each task, note:**
    - What was good about the output?
    - What needed editing?
    - How long would it have taken without AI?
3. **Bring to Session 2:** your best example and your worst example.

Next Session Preview

Session 2: Iterate, Critique, Trust

- The art of iteration — turning mediocre drafts into great ones
- The maker/checker framework formalized
- Skills and structured prompts for consistent output
- Build a reusable workflow for your recurring tasks

The Course Ahead

- Session 3: AI meets your enterprise data
- Session 4: From data to deliverables
- Sessions 5-6: Deployment and governance
- Sessions 7-8: Strategy and capstone